

Film Expert AI Assistant

Student Name: Xuqing Zhao

Student ID: 24207118

xuqing.zhao@ucdconnect.ie

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1. Introduction

This report is about building an intelligent AI assistant focused on the field of cinema using OpenAI's APIs. The idea is to create an AI assistant that can play the role of a professional film critic. The assistant is expected to provide not only in-depth and insightful analyses and critiques of specific directors' works, but also the answers are expected to be correctly informed, with no fabricated or factually incorrect answers about the film.

The motivation for creating this film assistant arose from a previous discussion about film with a large language model, during which several inaccuracies were identified in its answers. For example, during a conversation about *Stoker*, a film directed by South Korean filmmaker Park Chan-wook, ChatGPT gave me some answers that did not fit the facts of the film. One such example was ChatGPT returned "India discovers her uncle killing someone (or 'handling a body') in the basement, and the exterminator is the only person who witnesses the uncle's abnormal behavior." However, in the film, India does not witness her uncle committing a murder in the basement, and the person killed by her uncle is not the exterminator.

The project is developed based on OpenAI's API. First, set the assistant's identity and personality through system instructions, allowing him to play the role of an objective and insightful film critic. Next, Build a knowledge base as a local resource for Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG). Used to inject custom, specific knowledge into the film field. Because of the above experience, I chose director Park Chan-wook and built a knowledge archive of his biography; his films *Decision to Leave*, *The Handmaiden*, and *Stoker*; as well as the genre of Film noir. These resources provide the assistant with in-depth field knowledge about Park Chan-wook's signature style, creative themes, and the background, narrative, characters, art style, and themes of the major films he directed. This information is collated from Wikipedia, director interviews, and professional film review articles. Finally, the assistant employs OpenAI's Function Calling interface. So it can fetch real-time ratings, box-office numbers and other up-to-date metadata to keep its responses timely and authentic.

2. Assistant Design: A Schematic View

This project uses the `client.beta.assistants.create` API to launch a conversational assistant named Film Assistant, running on the `gpt-4o-mini` model. After this API is called, creating a thread assign a container to the conversation, where all user messages, tool invocations, and AI responses are recorded and managed.

Custom function tools first run a `vector_search` over knowledge base, when needed, call the TMDB API. This RAG not only helps LLM to deal with information-rich, complex and specialised tasks, but also enables continuous updating of the knowledge base information [3].

Film Assistant flow diagram is shown in Figure 1

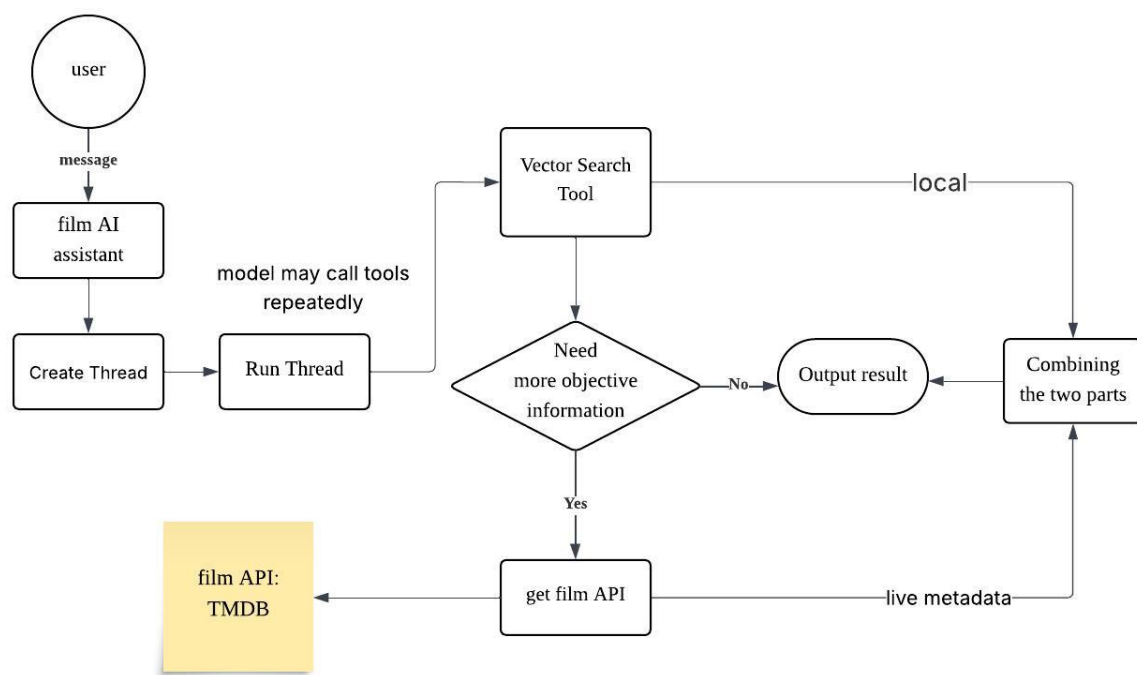


Figure 1: high-level view of diagram

3. Added Value: More than Mere ChatGPT

The knowledge covered by the corpus used in the training of the LLM model is not equal, so the performance of the LLM varies on different types of knowledge. This

limitation is particularly evident when faced with tasks that require the processing of domain-specific expertise [2].

Therefore, by integrating knowledge base of the film into RAG, compensated for the uneven coverage of the original training corpus. This provides professional background for the model to enable it to provide accurate and nuanced answers.

In addition, LLM has limited ability to update its knowledge. When confronted with queries that go beyond the point in time covered by the model's training data, LLMs often fabricate facts [2]. For this problem, the Film Assistant ensures access to the latest film data by calling the film API. Solve the problem of models making up answers because they don't have the latest data.

3.1 Tool Usage

Large language models (LLM) may generate results that are not related to user input or expectations, a phenomenon commonly referred to as 'hallucination.' In this project, it is hoped that the AI assistant will be able to avoid the 'hallucination' of film information and reviews. RAG improves the accuracy and relevance of the generated text by including a step to allow LLM to retrieve it from external sources before generating it. This reduces the risk of error and improves the quality of information available to the user. This is a very effective and practical tool [1]. So RAG was used for the project to try to avoid the 'hallucination' of film material and reviews.

The project used two retrieval methods. One is to search for pre-uploaded film material using a vector library hosted by OpenAI. The desired text fragments are then returned for LLM referencing. The other is a function call to the API to pull real-time information from The Movie DataBase (TMDB) <https://developers.themoviedb.org/3/getting-started/introduction>, such as release dates, box office, ratings, and so on.

4. Outside Knowledge: Curated Data Sources

There are two sources of data in RAG, the knowledge base and data retrieved from the API of TMDB.

The content of the dataset is information about a specific director, Park Chan-wook, including detailed descriptions and analyses of the films he has directed, the styles he specialises in, and the director's personal character biography. The data for the knowledge base was selected from Wikipedia, interviews with director Park Chan-wook, and film reviews. Information is extracted from the director interviews.

In this project, I made five knowledge bases, namely Park Chan-wook's personal knowledge base, the knowledge bases of the three films he has directed, and the knowledge bases of the genre of film noir that he specialises in. The examples of data are shown in Figure 2 and Figure 3

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# Park Chan-wook

## Basic Information
* Name: Park Chan-wook
* Date of Birth: August 23, 1963
* Nationality: South Korean
* Main Genres: Suspense, Thriller, Film Noir, Drama

## Overview of Directing Career
Born on 23 August 1963 in Seoul, South Korea, Park Chan-wook studied philosophy at Sogang University and participated in the photography and film club during his school years. His early works did not attract much attention, so he supported himself by writing film criticism and working as an assistant director.
He rose to fame in 2000 with Joint Security Area With the creative freedom that success brought, he launched his unofficial "Vengeance Trilogy"--Sympathy for Mr. Vengeance (2002), Oldboy (2003) and Lady Vengeance (2005)--establishing his strong personal style. Oldboy won the Grand Jury Prize at the 2004 Cannes Film Festival, marking his formal entry into the international film arena.
Since then, Park has balanced commercial appeal with artistic ambition: Thirst won the Cannes Jury Prize in 2009, Stoker was his English-language debut in 2013, and The Handmaiden earned BAFTA's Best Non-English Language Film in 2016. His latest film, Decision to Leave, won Best Director at Cannes in 2022.
He is known for exploring human darkness, moral ambiguity and emotional extremes within genre frameworks, and in recent years his style has shown a more introspective, mature side.

## Signature Stylistic Elements
### Visual Style and Photography
The film of Park Chan-wook has a distinct visual style characterized by his frequent use of wide-angle lenses, rapid zooms, push-pull shots, numerous close-ups of faces, and complex, fluid camera movements to create strong visual impact and psychological tension. His compositions are meticulously crafted, using space, lines, and geometric shapes to construct a sense of formal beauty.
Every scene and frame in Park Chan-wook's films reflects his meticulous control and deliberate design. One particularly clever and precisely executed shot can be found in «Sympathy for Mr. Vengeance». The camera begins in the room next door to Ryu's apartment, where four young men are masturbating, mistaking the sounds they hear for those of a woman in the throes of sexual pleasure. But as the camera slowly moves through their apartment and into Ryu's, we see his sister writhing in pain on the floor, desperately trying to get the attention of her deaf-mute brother-who sits with his back to her, silently eating dinner, seemingly indifferent to her suffering. In this tracking shot, Park infuses the scene with dark humor and tragic irony through the jarring way these characters share the same cinematic space.
He makes bold and symbolically rich use of color, with each film having its own dominant color palette. Park is especially skilled at using visual texture to create a unique atmosphere. For example, «The Handmaiden» employs highly saturated colors to present a vivid, baroque-style aesthetic, while «Decision to Leave» features an overall blue tone, aligning with the film's cold and intense emotional atmosphere.
Symbolic objects--such as octopuses, axes, shoes, pomegranates, and ants--and natural elements like mountains, the sea, snow, and cherry blossoms frequently appear in his films, serving as key carriers of narrative and thematic meaning.
Media like glass, mirrors, and screens are often used to create visual segmentation and layering. Through reflection and obstruction, these elements express character relationships, psychological states, or the blurred boundaries between reality and illusion.

### Narrative Structure
In terms of narrative, Park Chan-wook often employs non-linear storytelling and non-chapter structures, as seen in The Handmaiden. He disrupts the timeline and continually builds suspense through shifting character perspectives, then reveals the truth using flashbacks, interludes, and subjective viewpoints. He boldly experiments within genre conventions such as crime, thriller, revenge, and romance, breaking away from traditional narrative formulas. His plots are frequently accompanied by unexpected twists that challenge audience expectations, as exemplified in Oldboy. The relationships between characters are filled with deception, testing, and disguise.

### Violence and Dark Humor
Park Chan-wook's early and mid-career films are rich in dark humor and marked by the portrayal of violence and desire. Within scenes of extreme violence or tension, he often inserts absurd, bleak, or coldly humorous moments to balance the pacing of the film. He channels his characters' anger and repressed frustration into terrifying acts of violence. The brutal elements of violence in his films resonate strongly with the aesthetics of Asian extreme cinema, while the depth of emotional texture elevates them to the level of Greek tragedy. The characters' violent actions often stem from a compassionate love for others--an irony that brings with it an overwhelming sense of sorrow. However, this bold, stylized, and almost ritualistic approach becomes more restrained in Decision to Leave.

### Theme
Revenge is a central theme in many of Park Chan-wook's films, most notably in his renowned "Vengeance Trilogy." He is adept at exploring the motives and processes of revenge, the karmic cycles of fate that unfold between characters as a result, and the devastating consequences filled with sorrow and despair.
Characters in his films are often placed in extreme situations, operating within legal gray areas where moral boundaries are blurred. His narratives examine the choices people make when faced with such dire circumstances, revealing complex aspects of human nature.
At the same time, there are often deep divides between characters due to differences in identity, language, and hidden secrets. These gaps create a sense of constant surveillance and voyeurism, which in turn fuels misunderstanding and tension among characters.
Films don't shy away from the dark side of humanity. The people in Park's films are driven by powerful desires and obsessions--whether for love, control, or revenge. These irrational forces often dictate their
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Figure 2: Park Chan-wook

Decision to Leave

Basic Information

- * English Title: Decision to Leave
- * Director: Park Chan-wook
- * Screenwriters: Park Chan-wook, Jeong Seo-kyung
- * Lead Cast: Tang Wei (as Seo-rae), Park Hae-il (as Hae-jun), Lee Jung-hyun (as Ahn Jung-yeon), Ko Kyung-pyo (as Suh Woo-won)
- * Producer: Koh Tae-suk
- * Music: Cho Young-wuk
- * Cinematography: Kim Ji-yong
- * Editing: Kim Sang-bum
- * Production Company: Moho Film
- * Distributors: CJ Entertainment (Korea), Edko Films (Hong Kong/Macau), GARAGEPLAY Korea (Taiwan), MUBI (USA)
- * Running Time: 138 minutes
- * Languages: Korean, Mandarin
- * World Premiere: May 23, 2022 (75th Cannes Film Festival)
- * South Korea Release: June 29, 2022
- * Hong Kong/Taiwan Release: July 21 / July 15, 2022
- * Macau Release: September 8, 2022
- * South Korean Box Office: approximately 1.89 million admissions, USD 13.95 million
- * Worldwide Box Office: approximately USD 16.8 million

plot of the film

The film tells a complex, suspenseful and emotionally charged love story between police detective Jang Hae-jun and Chinese immigrant Song Seo-rae. While investigating the death of a retired immigration officer, South Korean police officer Jang Hae-jun gradually develops a crush on the young Chinese wife of the deceased, Song Seo-rae. Despite initially suspecting her to be the murderer, Hae-jun eventually concludes that the deceased committed suicide as he developed a crush on Song Seo-rae during the course of the investigation. However, as clues are uncovered, he discovers that Seo-rae is the real murderer. Even though Hae Joon finds out the evidence that Seo Rae murdered her own husband and forged an alibi, he still betrays his bottom line and principles and chooses to protect her. Seo-rae also gradually falls in love with Hae-jun in the process of testing and approaching him.

Thirteen months later, when Seo-rae is again involved in the death of her new husband, Hae-jun investigates again and finally confirms that she indirectly caused the death of another person using a series of carefully planned actions. In order to make Hae Joon remember her forever, Seo Rae chose to bury herself on the beach and drowned for the sake of this hopeless love. Hae Joon searches in agony but fails to find her body, leaving behind a deeply emotional and tragic end.

Narrative Characteristics

Decision to Leave follows a relatively complete, linear timeline that can be roughly divided into two segments—before and after the case is solved—yet it primarily advances through the investigative process of Detective Hae-jun. Midway through the film, a jump in time and change of setting introduces a second case, steering the narrative in the latter half toward new emotional depths. This dual-phase structure is not a repetition of perspective but a continuation of cause and effect, allowing the story to transcend conventional genre expectations and delve into more profound emotional territory. The film's humor is naturally woven into the suspense, providing moments of relief without undermining the overall atmosphere. Park Chan-wook makes extensive use of dreamlike transitions and montage, linking shots from different times and places—such as imagining the detective stepping into Seo-rae's world for a shared on-screen moment. This "simultaneous-but-separate" technique both creates an illusion of shape-shifting and maintains narrative coherence through rapid editing, immersing the viewer without causing confusion. Through fluid camera moves and dissolves almost throughout the film, Park visualizes Hae-jun's obsession with Seo-rae and their oscillating closeness. He has stated his intent to "go further" than a traditional genre ending: if the first half frames Seo-rae as a classic femme fatale deceiving the detective, the second half introduces a new narrative turn that subverts clichés and emphasizes a sense of romantic destiny. This anti-genre approach keeps viewers guessing, satisfying the intellectual thrill of a mystery while deepening the emotional engagement, making the film's structure all the more memorable and compelling. This film mix crime investigation with the development of a forbidden romance. The ending subverts both detective and romance conventions: Seo-rae's final act at the shore is simultaneously her ultimate confession of love and a sorrowful acknowledgment that these two cannot be together.

Character Analysis

In Decision to Leave, Hae-jun is a deeply complex character: a conscientious detective who carries out his work with meticulous precision, yet spends sleepless nights poring over cold cases and endures an emotionally barren marriage. Before meeting Seo-rae, his life is orderly but passionless; after meeting her, his reason and his feelings come into violent conflict. Seo-rae, while fitting the mold of a Park Chan-wook heroine, also breaks new ground: she appears fragile and enigmatic but possesses formidable inner strength. Though she bears the suspicion of a "black widow" (both her husbands died under suspicious circumstances), she also reveals a vulnerable, compassionate side—caring for the elderly and bearing the scars of domestic abuse—which engenders the audience's sympathy. A Chinese immigrant who survived family violence, she greets her husband's death with eerie calm, which raises suspicion. Yet as she spends time with Hae-jun—first as a subject of interrogation, then under informal surveillance—she transforms from a passive figure into an active participant, quietly drawing him into her world while concealing her past. Their relationship resembles a "soldier and outlaw" pairing. Nationality and language barriers further reinforce their divide: Seo-rae often speaks quietly to herself in Chinese or murmurs to her deceased husband, which Hae-jun cannot understand without a translation app—an element that both highlights their otherness and introduces moments of subtle humor. During the investigation, Seo-rae passively undergoes observation as a suspect, while Hae-jun's professional surveillance quickly seeps into his personal feelings. They are always separated by a layer of "glass"—whether the one-way mirror in the interrogation room or the window through which Seo-rae observes Hae-jun during her "house arrest." This physical separation mirrors the emotional boundary Park draws between them. Even though they develop intense feelings for one another, neither ever fully reveals their deepest secrets to the other. Seo-rae never confesses her crimes to Hae-jun, and he never fully admits his love or his doubts. They never share an overtly intimate moment; instead, stolen glances, the simple act of applying medication, and sharing an umbrella in the rain convey a restrained, East-Asian romantic yearning. Were the film to end after the first half—Seo-rae manipulating Hae-jun through her emotions—she would be nothing more than a femme fatale. Instead, Park extends the story into a second half in which she re-enters Hae-jun's life years later and ultimately pays the ultimate price for him, transforming her from a traditional "black widow" into a tragic figure wounded by love and deserving of our compassion. This subversion of genre archetypes makes Hae-jun no mere dupe of a beautiful manipulator; his character becomes fully three-dimensional, torn between professional honor, moral obligation, human vulnerability, and uncontrollable obsession. Both protagonists inhabit moral gray zones, yet their genuine emotions prevent the audience from feeling alienated—instead, we are captivated by their complexity.

Notably, although Hae-jun and Seo-rae develop profound love for one another, "neither ever reveals their innermost secret." Seo-rae never confesses her guilt, and Hae-jun never directly confronts his love or his suspicions. They never utter the words "I love you"; even this simplest confession is deliberately omitted by Park Chan-wook. Their mutual withholding and restraint only intensify the tragedy: they love each other

Figure 3: Decision to Leave

furthermore, In order to ensure that the Film Assistant has access to the most up-to-date and authentic film data, it calls The TMDb API when needed. The API is primarily responsible for providing basic information about the film, such as cast, genre, and vote counts. It ensures that the model has access to the most up-to-date information about the film.

5. Worked Examples: Your Assistant in Action

The assistant is set up as a professional film critic. who focuses on in-depth analyses of film, including narrative, character analysis, cinematography, music, film themes, historical context and emotional resonance. And its reviewing style is objective and insightful.

To test the film assistant’s performance in the film review task, I set up three examples.

The first example is about *Stoker* and my question is "*we can pick a few key scenes from Stoker together to analyse specifically where the emotional breaks are. For example, India’s first murder, her dialogue with her mother, her uncle’s time with her, etc.*"

The answer of ChatGPT (4o): <https://chatgpt.com/c/68157754-0e4c-800d-b7e0-407f17dead85>. ChatGPT's answer has several inaccuracies, For instance, it said *"Scene: India kills the sheriff who comes to investigate her uncle."* and *"India showers and begins to experience pleasure from the memory of the killing."* However, in the film, the sheriff doesn't investigate India's uncle and after the killing the film ends immediately. there is no shower scene depicting India experiencing pleasure from recalling the murder.

Film Assistant's answer is shown in Figure 4

"Stoker," directed by Park Chan-wook, is a psychological thriller that intricately explores themes of grief, repression, and awakening through its protagonist, India Stoker. Here are a few key scenes that warrant close analysis for their emotional resonance:

1. India's First Murder

This pivotal scene marks a significant turning point in India's character development. The murder embodies her emotional awakening and shift from a passive observer to an active participant in her dark inherited impulses. The tension is palpable as she transitions from fear to exhilaration. The cinematography—crafted with stark contrasts and a meticulous color palette—enhances the psychological weight of the moment. The depiction of blood—richly symbolic in this context—underscores the awakening of her repressed desires. This experience opens the door to her dark potential and foreshadows her increasingly violent trajectory.

2. Dialogue with Her Mother, Evelyn

India's interactions with her mother are laden with tension and unresolved emotion. Evelyn represents both a maternal figure and a source of oppression. Their conversations often reflect India's inner turmoil and isolation. Analyzing the subtext in their exchanges reveals how Evelyn's eerie calmness contrasts with India's burgeoning intensity. The dialogue is structured to reveal the emotional chasm between them, showcasing India's struggle for identity while trapped in her mother's controlling shadow. Ultimately, this dynamic complicates the theme of familial bonds and the weight of inheritance.

3. India's Relationship with Uncle Charlie

Charlie's arrival introduces a complex dynamic. His charm masks sinister undertones, and as India develops an attraction toward him, viewers witness a complex interplay of emotions—confusion, fear, intrigue. Analyze the moments when she observes him, allowing the cinematography to accentuate their chemistry and the underlying threat he poses. This relationship embodies themes of forbidden desire and moral ambiguity, raising questions about the nature of familial relationships and the dark allure of the unknown. India's evolving perception of Charlie serves as a reflection of her internal conflict, transitioning from admiration to apprehension to complicity.

Emotional Breaks

In each of these scenes, the emotional breaks occur at critical junctures:

- **Realization** during India's first murder leads to an infusion of strength but raises questions about morality.
 - **Vulnerability** during her dialogues with Evelyn highlights her internal conflict, showing the emotional burden of familial expectations.
 - **Awakening** through her interactions with Charlie showcases her desire for liberation from her repressive environment but also the danger of indulgence in darkness.
- In examining these scenes, "Stoker" brilliantly employs cinematography, sound design, and sharp dialogue to elevate the emotional stakes, painting a portrait of a young woman caught between the chains of her upbringing and her own burgeoning identity. Each moment serves as a building block for her transformation, making the exploration of these emotional breaks essential for understanding her character arc.

Figure 4: Question about Stoker

The film assistant(gpt-4o-mini) didn't answer specific details of the killings, but there was nothing about his responses that didn't match the film. I'm relieved that this reply isn't incorrect, but since I've already written about India's killings in dataset, I'm a little disappointed that the film assistant didn't know it.

The second example is about *Desicion to Leave* and *The Handmaiden*.I asked a very subjective question with no standard answer *"Why the love story in Decision to Leave to be more moving for me than the love story in The Handmaiden."*

The answer of ChatGPT (4o-mini): <https://chatgpt.com/share/68161af7-e848-800d-abe1-26bee1d0055e>. ChatGPT's answer was very succinct. He briefly compared the two films in terms of their characters, atmosphere, and themes.

Film Assistant's answer is shown in Figure 5

Your emotional connection to the love story in *Decision to Leave* as more moving than that of *The Handmaiden* could stem from several key elements that resonate on a personal level. These elements include the nature of the protagonists' love, the emotional depth and moral complexity of their relationship, and the film's poignant portrayal of sacrifice and tragedy.

1. Emotional Depth and Complexity

In *Decision to Leave*, the love story between Detective Hae-jun and Seo-rae is fraught with emotional and moral complexity. Both characters are deeply flawed, facing their own loneliness and moral dilemmas. Hae-jun, despite his role as a detective, struggles with a stagnant marriage and a profound sense of isolation. Seo-rae, as a Chinese immigrant, carries the burdens of past trauma, including the suspicions surrounding her husband's death [8:0*source] [8:1*source]. This layered complexity evokes sympathy and a profound emotional connection, as viewers witness their struggles and hopes intermingle against a backdrop of suspicion and moral ambiguity. The nature of their love is one where they are constantly separated by their respective circumstances—law and crime, duty and desire—which creates a tension that resonates with viewers. The moments of connection, such as sharing an umbrella in the rain or climbing mountains together, are imbued with an emotional weight that elevates their relationship to one of tragic yearning [8:1*source] [8:5*source]. This yearning is intensified by the film's tragic climax, where Seo-rae's ultimate sacrifice—allowing herself to become an unsolved mystery to preserve Hae-jun's integrity—adds a haunting sense of beauty to their love [8:0*source].

2. Tragic Romance

Decision to Leave employs a narrative approach that emphasizes tragedy over triumph. Unlike traditional love stories that often culminate in reunions or resolutions, this film concludes with a heartbreaking parting that underscores the pain of unattainable love. The film's final scenes linger in the mind, presenting a love story that is not only beautiful but also steeped in sorrow. The deep emotional resonance lies in the tragedy that unfolds—not necessarily a conventional happy ending, but one that reflects the complexities and sacrifices inherent in their love [8:0*source] [8:2*source]. This approach can evoke a more profound emotional response, as viewers are left to grapple with the implications of love's compromises.

3. Personal Reflection and Moral Dilemmas

Your connection to the love story in *Decision to Leave* may also be influenced by the film's exploration of moral dilemmas and human vulnerability. Hae-jun's inability to fully confront his feelings for Seo-rae, coupled with her secrets, creates a barrier that viewers can empathize with—a feeling of wanting to understand and forgive, even when faced with moral transgressions [8:4*source] [8:5*source]. This exploration of love intertwined with duty, suspicion, and ethical challenges resonates on a personal level, prompting reflections on how far one might go for love and the consequences that such choices entail.

In Contrast: *The Handmaiden*

On the other hand, while *The Handmaiden* features a compelling love story, it primarily functions as a revenge thriller and liberation narrative. The emotional impact stems from themes of empowerment and social justice rather than the intricacies of romantic sacrifice. The resolution of *The Handmaiden* offers a sense of triumph, which can sometimes overshadow the intimate emotional experiences between the characters [8:15*source] [8:16*source]. This difference in narrative focus might not resonate as deeply on a personal level compared to the tragic and nuanced approach of *Decision to Leave*, especially if you find greater resonance in stories that emphasize longing, loss, and moral ambiguity.

Conclusion

Ultimately, the moving nature of the love story in *Decision to Leave* may align more closely with themes that evoke sorrow, moral conflict, and tragic beauty. The emotional complexity, character isolation, and profound sacrifices depicted create an intensely moving experience that can linger long after viewing, appealing to a deeper exploration of the complexities of love and human experience. These elements combine to form a narrative that, for many viewers, feels more personally resonant than the love story presented in *The Handmaiden*.

Figure 5: Film Compare

The film assistant also answers questions from several arguments. However, compared to ChatGPT, the tone of his answer is closer to that of a human, while citing some correct details from the film to argue the point. This response was impressive. Because he accurately surmised my emotional tendencies and that point resonated with me.

The third example is about film genres. My question is "*The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo with film noir*".

The answer of ChatGPT (4o-mini): <https://chatgpt.com/c/68164337-8204-800d-8a30-44d0a50b2086>. ChatGPT analyses the film's relationship with noir elements from different angles.

Film Assistant's answer is shown in Figure 6

The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo can be examined through the lens of film noir, despite not being a traditional film noir. Here's an analysis focusing on how it aligns with and diverges from the classic noir elements:

Film Noir Characteristics in *The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo*

1. **Moral Ambiguity:**
 - Classic noir often features morally complex characters who navigate a shadowy world of deceit and corruption. Mikael Blomkvist and Lisbeth Salander fit this mold, as both operate in morally gray areas. Blomkvist is a disgraced journalist with a questionable ethical background, and Salander, while a victim of systemic abuse, employs methods that blur the lines of legality.
2. **Atmospheric Cinematography:**
 - David Fincher's direction captures a dark, moody atmosphere reminiscent of classic noir. The use of shadows, dim lighting, and urban settings creates an oppressive and tense environment that parallels the emotional and psychological weight of the story.
3. **Femme Fatale Archetype:**
 - Lisbeth Salander serves as a modern interpretation of the femme fatale, a staple of film noir. However, she subverts the trope; rather than being a manipulative seductress, she is a survivor and a determined avenger, wielding her intelligence and hacking skills as her primary weapons.
4. **Themes of Isolation and Betrayal:**
 - Both traditional film noir and *The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo* explore themes of isolation and betrayal. Blomkvist's investigation reveals deep-seated familial betrayal and corporate corruption, and Salander's backstory emphasizes her isolation and the betrayal she has faced throughout her life.
5. **Complex Narrative:**
 - The film's intricate plot, which weaves together multiple storylines, is characteristic of many noir films. The unfolding mystery involves both personal and systemic corruption, striking at divergent threads of society—corporate greed and family secrets.
6. **Psychological Tension:**
 - Much like classic noir films, the psychological depth of the characters adds to the tension. The exploration of Salander's traumatic past and Blomkvist's moral dilemmas adds layers of psychological complexity typical of the noir style.

Divergences from Traditional Noir

- **Resolution:** While many noir films often conclude with a sense of hopelessness and moral degradation, *The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo* offers a more complex resolution that leaves room for justice, albeit at a high personal cost.
- **Protagonist's Agency:** Traditional noir often features passive protagonists who are swept along by circumstances. In contrast, both Blomkvist and Salander demonstrate significant agency, actively driving the narrative forward.

Conclusion

The Girl with the Dragon Tattoo embodies many elements of film noir, particularly in its exploration of dark themes, morally ambiguous characters, and stylistic choices. However, it also evolves the genre by offering a modern perspective on agency and justice, employing contemporary storytelling techniques that resonate within the framework of traditional noir.

Figure 6: Film Genre

The Film Assistant and ChatGPT answers are similar, except that the Film Assistant's answers are more detailed.

6. Summary and Conclusions

This project allows Film Assistants to access more in-depth, authentic film knowledge through a local vectorized knowledge base and the TMDB API.

However, the current database is far from perfect. In the future, the database can be further expanded according to different dimensions, such as directors, genres, and actors. It can also access more open APIs, such as IMDb, Rotten Tomatoes and so on. The assistant can cross-retrieve from multiple places to further improve the accuracy and completeness.

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The work in this report is entirely my own work. All external sources have been appropriately cited.

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